

HUMAN

COMMON HUMAN HUMANOID

Erbium Industries would prefer history to remember humans as the only people who ever called **Wander** home. Humans were probably Wander's first native sapient ancestry, but by the time the **Star Dream** transformed the Settled Systems, the planet had become home to many peoples. Most physical evidence disappeared with Wander, and Erbium controls the largest surviving archives. The distinction between historical truth and corporate inheritance is therefore difficult to prove.

Erbium Industries LLC began as a human-founded corporation on Wander, and humans remain disproportionately represented throughout its executive, administrative, legal, and financial authorities. The corporation is not legally an aristocracy. Its senior officials simply possess the money, educational access, professional networks, family connections, and advance knowledge necessary to ensure that their children remain competitive for senior positions. Workers sometimes call these entrenched households **ladder families**, because each generation begins several rungs above everyone else while Erbium continues to describe advancement as a purely merit-based process.

This historical advantage extends beyond employment. Much of the Settled Systems' infrastructure was first standardized around human bodies, human languages, and human environmental tolerances. Common descends from Wander Slant, early pressure suits were fitted around human proportions, medical formularies use human biology as their reference point, and many identity systems were designed around human names, faces, and biometrics. Other ancestries frequently refer to this collection of assumptions as the **Human Default**.

Individual humans do not necessarily benefit from that default in equal measure. Humans outside corporate families experience the same debt, coerced service, housing instability, surveillance, and dangerous labor as their neighbors. An impoverished human can be treated as the ordinary population for whom no special assistance is necessary, even when ordinary assistance does not exist.

Ancestry-targeted relief programs were created in response to documented discrimination against nonhuman communities, but these programs are usually underfunded, tightly means-tested, and administered through systems that benefit Erbium. Impoverished humans are often excluded because their suffering is classified as



general economic hardship rather than ancestry-specific harm. Nonhuman communities still receive less assistance than they need, while struggling humans are told that aid went elsewhere. Erbium benefits whenever both groups blame one another for scarcity created by corporate policy.

Humans are now found throughout the Settled Systems and along much of the known frontier. Their prevalence does not come from a unique immunity to hostile environments. Human settlers are unusually willing to establish communities before a world is comfortable, rely on temporary habitats for generations, import familiar ecosystems, accept extensive medical adaptation, and continue expanding while terraforming remains incomplete. Erbium also possesses more standardized equipment for human workers, making human settlement cheaper under corporate projections even when it is no safer.

If you want an adaptable character whose identity can be shaped by corporate privilege, frontier hardship, lost history, or life between several communities, you should play a human.

YOU MIGHT...

- ◆ Approach unfamiliar environments as conditions to be learned, modified, endured, or made habitable.
- ◆ Define yourself through your homeworld, profession, family, or community more strongly than through humanity as a whole.
- ◆ Carry pride, grief, resentment, or suspicion regarding Wander and the history Erbium claims on humanity's behalf.

OTHERS PROBABLY...

- ◆ Assume institutions were designed for you, even when poverty, disability, class, or local prejudice keeps you from benefiting from them.
- ◆ Associate you with Erbium's founders, executives, and official history regardless of your actual relationship with the corporation.
- ◆ View human adaptability as admirable persistence, reckless expansion, or a willingness to reshape places without fully understanding them.

PHYSICAL DESCRIPTION

Humans display extensive variation in skin tone, facial structure, hair color and texture, height, body composition, and visible ancestry. Centuries of interplanetary settlement have increased that variation through ordinary inheritance, medical intervention, environmental adaptation, and cosmetic modification.

Humans born on different worlds often develop recognizable regional characteristics without constituting separate ancestries. Long-term residents of low-gravity settlements may be taller and more lightly built, though most receive bone-density treatments and resistance training throughout childhood. Humans from high-gravity worlds tend to be shorter, denser, and more heavily muscled. Communities exposed to strong ultraviolet

radiation commonly possess darker pigmentation or engineered protective traits. Frontier populations frequently combine inherited adaptations with cheap or improvised medical treatments, producing results that vary widely between settlements.

The buoyant cities of **Theosis** have produced generations of humans accustomed to reduced gravity, sealed interiors, pressure drills, and sulfur-filtered air systems. Theosis-born humans often wear compression garments beneath ordinary clothing and receive routine skeletal monitoring. Senior corporate families can afford extensive preventative care, while lower-deck workers frequently manage chronic bone, joint, and circulatory problems through employer-issued treatments tied to continued service.

Human appearance is also influenced by occupation. Corporate officials favor controlled, regulation-compliant presentation, while frontier workers often adopt clothing designed for heat, dust, radiation, moisture, or local wildlife. Tattoos, scarification, replacement limbs, cosmetic implants, retinal modifications, and visible medical ports are all common. Erbium maintains strict appearance policies in some public-facing positions while describing such restrictions as customer-confidence standards.

SOCIETY

There is no single human society within the Settled Systems. Humans are spread across nearly every major government, settlement, profession, and economic class. A human raised in a Theosis executive household may have less culturally in common with a human rancher on **Agrio Dysis IV** than either has with a nonhuman neighbor from the same community.

Human political power is nevertheless difficult to separate from Erbium's history. The corporation's oldest charters, educational institutions, credentialing boards, legal departments, and financial offices were established primarily by humans. Even where formal ancestry restrictions are prohibited, established families can pass professional preparation from one generation to the next. Their children attend approved schools, receive supervised internships, learn corporate etiquette, and enter employment with personal recommendations from senior staff.

Erbium celebrates these outcomes as proof that stable households produce qualified leadership. Corporate histories rarely mention that the same households helped determine what qualifications would be required.

Many ordinary humans work directly for Erbium as technicians, clerks, administrators, service personnel, security workers, logistics coordinators, terraformers, agricultural laborers, and frontier extraction crews. Others work for governments and contractors whose policies are shaped by Erbium's infrastructure. A human employee may possess ancestry advantages within a workplace while remaining disposable to the corporation itself.

This contradiction produces resentment in several directions. Some nonhumans view humans as the face of a system that treats their bodies and communities as exceptions. Some impoverished humans resent being told they are privileged while facing eviction, medical debt, Great Volunteering, or lethal working conditions.

Reactionary organizations exploit that resentment by blaming ancestry-targeted relief programs, immigration, or nonhuman advancement. Erbium suppresses such groups when they threaten production but often tolerates them when their anger remains directed away from corporate leadership.

Human communities also form much of the Settled Systems' frontier population. Erbium and aligned governments frequently offer settlement grants, transport subsidies, equipment loans, and temporary land rights to people willing to establish a presence on marginal worlds. These programs are advertised as opportunities for independence. Many function as debt displacement, moving unemployed populations away from major cities and converting them into customers dependent on corporate supply chains.

Humans adapt quickly to local customs and regularly form blended communities with other ancestries. Common's human origin gives them an advantage in administration and trade, but human cultures also absorb words, clothing, foods, rituals, and social structures from neighboring peoples. Some humans interpret this flexibility as proof that humanity has no fixed identity. Others regard adaptation itself as the defining human tradition.

BELIEFS

Human beliefs are as varied as their settlements. Humans follow organized religions, local philosophies, corporate doctrines, family traditions, ancestral practices, and personal ethical systems. Some treat the Star Dream as revelation, while others interpret it as a technological event whose religious meaning was imposed afterward.

A recurring human value is the belief that circumstances can be changed. This can inspire mutual aid, resistance, exploration, invention, and the construction of viable communities in hostile places. It can also justify aggressive terraforming, cultural assimilation, endless economic expansion, and the assumption that any obstacle exists to be overcome.

Corporate human culture emphasizes advancement, service, continuity, and measurable achievement. Employees are encouraged to treat promotions, housing access, medical coverage, and family security as rewards earned through correct participation. Failure is framed as evidence that a person did not prepare, comply, or work efficiently enough.

Frontier human cultures usually place greater emphasis on practical independence, reciprocal obligation, and loyalty to people physically present. A distant government or corporation may possess formal authority, but survival depends on neighbors who repair pumps, share water, track storms, defend livestock, and respond when communications fail.

Wander remains central to many human identities despite the lack of reliable information about it. Some humans treat Wander as a sacred lost homeland. Others reject a planet they never knew and resent Erbium's use of its destruction as a claim to authority. Many families preserve contradictory stories about where they lived, what their ancestors did, and whether they escaped before the final disaster.

Popular Edicts adapt to changing conditions, protect those who depend on you, build or preserve a viable home, improve your circumstances, remember where you came from without allowing official history to define you

Popular Anathema abandon dependents for personal convenience, destroy a functioning community without necessity, treat another person’s hardship as proof of their inferiority, surrender your agency without considering an alternative

SAMPLE NAMES

Human naming traditions vary by family, world, language, religion, and profession. Common names include Akif, Amara, Ana, Bao, Cassian, Dalia, Elias, Farah, Hadzi, Imani, Jalen, Keiko, Korva, Luz, Mateo, Nadiya, Navasi, Omar, Priya, Rafi, Razia, Sora, Tamsin, Valen, Yara, Yon, and Zeke.

Some corporate families preserve surnames associated with Wander’s early industries, government offices, or academic institutions. Frontier settlers may adopt names based on towns, ships, work crews, landmarks, or local events. It is common for a person to use different forms of their name in family, employment, and government contexts.

OTHER INFORMATION

WANDER AND HUMAN MEMORY

Humans were probably the first sapient people native to Wander, but Erbium’s preferred version of that claim goes much further. Corporate histories often portray Wander as an exclusively human civilization whose technology and natural resources were generously shared with later arrivals.

Surviving independent accounts indicate that many ancestries lived on Wander before its destruction and contributed to its scientific, industrial, cultural, and political life. The planet’s population records are incomplete, and some appear to have been altered during the evacuation and subsequent continuity proceedings.

Erbium uses human association with Wander to support its own legitimacy. Corporate ceremonies present the company as the surviving vessel of Wander’s civilization, allowing loyalty to Erbium to be framed as loyalty to humanity’s lost home.

Human responses differ. Some embrace the connection and believe Erbium preserved civilization after an unavoidable disaster. Some distinguish human history from corporate history. Others believe Erbium destroyed the only world that could have proven its claims false.

THE HUMAN DEFAULT

The Human Default is an informal term for the widespread use of human bodies, language, and social conventions as the assumed norm of Settled Systems infrastructure.

Human-standard doors, furniture, tools, protective equipment, medication, nutritional guidance, biometric scanners, educational testing, and workplace schedules remain common. Many products now include ancestry accommodations, but these are frequently treated as optional modifications rather than ordinary design requirements.

The default does not serve all humans equally. Disabled humans, people with extensive augmentation, low-gravity adaptations, unusual body proportions, and medical conditions can also be excluded by systems described as human-compatible.

Because these standards are embedded throughout Erbium infrastructure, external governments usually adopt them for interoperability and cost control. Officials describe the decision as technical standardization rather than ancestry policy.

THEOSIS

The buoyant cities of Theosis contain one of the largest concentrations of humans in the Settled Systems. Erbium's senior administration, engineering authorities, legal offices, and financial divisions maintain significant operations there, and many ladder families consider Theosis the center of respectable corporate life.

Theosis is frequently presented as evidence of human prosperity. Its upper districts contain prestigious schools, controlled gardens, private medical facilities, stable pressure environments, and residences buffered from industrial noise and atmospheric disturbance.

Most humans on Theosis do not live in those districts. They maintain pressure envelopes, structural supports, cargo systems, stabilizers, transit infrastructure, sanitation networks, and emergency separation mechanisms. Their continued employment may determine access to housing, medicine, and safe atmospheric zones.

Theosis therefore produces two conflicting stereotypes. Corporate media presents the polished human official whose success proves Erbium rewards merit. Workers throughout the Settled Systems are more familiar with the exhausted human technician whose family remains one missed shift away from losing pressure-rated housing.

AGRIO DYSIS IV

Agrio Dysis IV, commonly called **the Low Plane**, is a refuge and settlement world near the established frontier. Its largest inhabited region is an immense sunken continental basin surrounded by dry uplands and

broken mountain chains. The basin experiences intense heat, long dry seasons, violent storm fronts, and periodic flooding along its few dependable river systems.

The world was settled through a combination of government relocation programs, private land charters, religious communities, independent migrants, and Erbium-backed agricultural contracts. Many settlers were promised land, equipment, and reduced dependency on major corporate systems. Most arrived owing transportation and equipment debt.

Imported cattle and engineered grazing animals thrive across portions of the basin, making ranching, water management, livestock transport, veterinary work, and hide processing central to many local economies. Settlements cluster around wells, rail depots, river crossings, landing fields, and seasonal trade routes. These communities are commonly called cattle towns even when most residents work in repair, freight, hospitality, or water administration.

Traditional Low Plane clothing includes a tall, creased crown with a wide curved brim and replaceable hatband. The design protects the face and neck from heat, glare, dust, and sudden rain while allowing local workers to display town, ranch, family, or occupational affiliations through the band. Long dust coats, ventilated work shirts, reinforced boots, and neck coverings are also common.

Local culture emphasizes practical competence, hospitality under harsh conditions, personal reputation, and suspicion of authorities who appear only to collect payments or enforce contracts. Communities rely heavily on mutual aid while maintaining intense disputes over land, water access, grazing rights, and corporate ownership.

The Low Plane is marketed as proof that humans can build lives anywhere. Erbium rarely mentions how many settlers were sent there because established worlds had no intention of supporting them.

PLACE IN THE SETTLED SYSTEMS

Humans occupy nearly every layer of the Settled Systems. They serve as corporate executives, government officials, clerks, engineers, farmers, terraformers, educators, soldiers, miners, ranchers, transport workers, technicians, and settlement laborers. They are especially common in fields where legacy Erbium credentials, human-standard equipment, or Common-language administration provide an advantage.



Their widespread presence makes human characters compatible with almost any assignment, but their background should still answer where they fit within human society. A human from a Theosis ladder family experiences Erbium differently from a pressure technician, a Low Plane rancher, a Wander memorialist, or a debt settler assigned to a frontier colony.

Humans frequently enter Frontier Extraction Division service as survey personnel, mechanics, agricultural specialists, logistics workers, junior administrators, security contractors, terraforming technicians, and settlement coordinators. Some see service as a path upward. Others enter because established systems have made remaining home impossible.

HUMAN MECHANICS

HIT POINTS

8

SIZE

Medium

SPEED

25 feet

ATTRIBUTE BOOSTS

Two free attribute boosts

LANGUAGES

Common

Additional languages equal to 1 + your Intelligence modifier, if it is positive. Choose from the list of common languages and any other languages to which you have access, such as languages prevalent on your home world.

Heritages

CATACLYST HUMAN

You're the child of a dead world or doomed civilization, a lost offshoot of humanity that perished due to invasion, natural disaster, or war. You've grown cautious and learned from your people's shattered past, determined to break destructive patterns and reclaim your place in the galaxy.

The circumstance bonus to initiative rolls you gain when you or an ally uses the **Scout** exploration activity is +2 instead of +1. When you roll initiative, you can **Stand** or **Step** as a reaction.

PIONEER HUMAN

You might be the child of explorers, interstellar colonists, or diplomats stationed on distant worlds far away from home. You feel an insatiable wanderlust to travel and explore, and this resolve helps protect you from succumbing to dangers you might encounter during your travels.

At 1st level, choose cold or heat. For the chosen element, environmental effects are one step less extreme (incredible heat becomes extreme, extreme cold becomes severe, and so on). You also become trained **Survival**. If you would automatically become trained in Survival (from your background or class, for example), you instead become trained in another skill of your choice. You also gain the **Terrain Expertise** skill feat.

SKILLED HUMAN

Your ingenuity allows you to train in a wide variety of skills. You become trained in one skill of your choice. At 5th level, you become an expert in the chosen skill.

URBANITE HUMAN

You have grown up in a big city and are accustomed to the press and pull of the largest crowds, the electric buzz and tangle of streets, or the dense nature of vertical living on a station or megaplex. You **ignore difficult terrain** from crowds and lesser cover from crowds. You become trained in a Lore skill for one specific city of your choice.

VERSATILE HUMAN

Humans were the most common ancestry on Golarion before that world disappeared, and they've since spread to the stars thanks to their versatility. Select a general feat of your choice for which you meet the prerequisites (as with your ancestry feat, you can select this general feat at any point during character creation).